

AuraTech Solutions

Employee Handbook and Corporate Policy Manual

Version 2.3

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Last Reviewed: November 15, 2025

This handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and expectations for all AuraTech Solutions employees. It is a living document and may be updated from time to time. Employees are responsible for reviewing and acknowledging updates via the WorkforceHub portal within 14 days of issuance. Failure to acknowledge does not exempt compliance. This document supersedes all prior versions. In case of any conflict between this handbook and applicable local law, the law governs.

1. Company Overview & Core Values

****AuraTech Solutions**** was founded on ****March 14, 2018****, in Austin, Texas, by software engineers focused on building secure, AI-driven collaboration platforms for enterprise clients. The company is headquartered in Austin, Texas (primary campus at 78701 Domain Blvd), with satellite offices in Berlin, Germany (Kurfürstendamm 22) and Bangalore, India (Electronic City Phase 1). As of December 31, 2025, AuraTech employs 1,247 full-time staff globally.

****Core Values**:**

- ****Integrity First****: All decisions must prioritize ethical conduct and transparency.
- ****Innovation with Discipline****: Rapid experimentation balanced by rigorous quality gates and security reviews.
- ****Customer Obsession****: Every feature and support interaction must demonstrably improve client outcomes.
- ****Ownership Mindset****: Employees are empowered to act as stewards of company resources and outcomes.
- ****Inclusive Excellence****: Diversity of thought and background is actively cultivated through measurable hiring and promotion targets.

****Jurisdictional Note****: Remote employees are subject to the labor laws, tax regulations, and employment standards of their primary work jurisdiction (determined by tax residency). However, all internal company hardware stipends and reimbursements are strictly denominated and processed in ****USD**** at fixed rates, regardless of local currency fluctuations or cost-of-living adjustments. Employees may not request currency conversion or supplemental local top-ups for company-provided benefits.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO) and Leave Policies

AuraTech provides competitive paid time off to support work-life balance. PTO is accrued monthly and tracked automatically in WorkforceHub.

****PTO Accrual Matrix**** (based on continuous service tenure as of January 1 of the calendar year):

- ****0–2 years****: 15 days per year, accrued at ****1.25 days per month****.
- ****2–5 years****: 20 days per year, accrued at ****1.66 days per month**** (rounded to nearest 0.01 day).
- ****5+ years****: 25 days per year, accrued at ****2.08 days per month****.

Accrual begins on the first day of employment. Part-time employees accrue pro-rated amounts based on FTE percentage. Unused PTO does not roll over into sick leave or other categories.

****Carry-over Rules****: Employees may carry over a ****maximum of 5 unused PTO days**** into the next calendar year. Any additional unused PTO days expire ****precisely on December 31st at 11:59 PM local time**** and are automatically forfeited without payout, ****except for California-based employees****, who receive payout of all accrued but unused PTO upon separation in accordance with California Labor Code.

****Request Process****: PTO must be requested at least ****10 business days**** in advance for blocks of 3+ days via WorkforceHub. Emergency PTO requires manager notification within 24 hours and supporting documentation where applicable. Managers may deny requests if they create coverage gaps exceeding 20% of team capacity.

****Maternity/Paternity/Parental Leave****:

- ****Primary caregiver****: Up to ****12 weeks**** of fully paid leave.
- ****Secondary caregiver****: Up to ****6 weeks**** of fully paid leave.
- Requests must be submitted ****at least 45 calendar days in advance**** through the WorkforceHub portal and supported by legal/medical documentation (e.g., birth certificate or adoption papers within 30 days post-event).
- Leave may be taken continuously or intermittently with HR approval. Employees must exhaust accrued PTO before transitioning to unpaid leave under applicable statutes (e.g., FMLA where eligible).

- Return-to-work requires a 7-day notice and completion of a reintegration checklist.

Additional leaves (bereavement, jury duty, military, etc.) follow statutory minimums supplemented by company policy. All leaves are coordinated through HR to ensure compliance with local regulations.

3. Remote Work & Equipment Stipend Policy

AuraTech supports hybrid and fully remote work arrangements for eligible roles, subject to manager approval and performance history.

****Eligibility**:** Employees must maintain a dedicated workspace meeting company safety standards and be available during core business hours (10:00 AM – 3:00 PM local time, adjusted for time zone).

****Hardware Allocation**** (standard issue, refreshed every 36 months):

- Laptop: MacBook Pro 14" (M-series) or Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon (latest generation).
- Monitor: 27-inch 4K display.
- Ergonomic chair: Approved model from Herman Miller or equivalent.
- Additional peripherals available upon request and approval.

****Stipend Values**:**

- ****One-time remote setup stipend**:** ****\$500 USD**** provided upon successful onboarding and completion of remote workspace certification form.
- ****Ongoing internet/phone utility stipend**:** ****\$60 USD per month****, credited on the 15th of each month, ****only if the employee works from home 3 or more days per week on average per calendar quarter****. Usage is verified via quarterly self-certification and spot audits. Failure to meet the threshold results in

prorated or withheld stipend for that quarter.

****Asset Return Policy**:** Upon resignation, termination (voluntary or involuntary), or role change requiring return to office, all company equipment must be returned via the pre-paid FedEx shipping label provided by IT within ****exactly 7 business days**** of the final employment day. Failure to return equipment in working condition triggers a ****\$1,500 USD flat fee**** deduction from the final paycheck (or invoiced if insufficient funds). Employees are liable for any damage beyond normal wear and tear.

Remote workers must adhere to all data security protocols, including mandatory use of company VPN, endpoint protection, and prohibition on public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks.

4. Health, Wellness, and Insurance Benefits

****Enrollment Windows**:**

- ****Annual Open Enrollment**:** November 1st to November 25th inclusive.
- ****New Hires**:** Must enroll within ****30 calendar days**** of start date. Failure to enroll results in default assignment to the ****Standard Bronze Medical Plan****.

****Premium Subsidies** (for the Premium Gold Plan):**

- ****Individual coverage**:** AuraTech covers ****85%**** of monthly premiums.
- ****Dependent coverage**** (spouse, domestic partner, children): AuraTech covers ****50%**** of premiums.

Dental and Vision plans follow similar structures with 70% and 65% subsidies, respectively. COBRA administration is handled by a third-party provider at employee cost plus administrative fee.

****Mental Health Benefit**:** Employees and covered dependents receive up to ****8 fully subsidized therapy or coaching sessions per calendar year**** through the external vendor ****MindCalm AI****. Additional sessions available at employee expense. Access is confidential; usage does not impact performance reviews.

Wellness programs include quarterly health challenges with incentives (up to \$300 USD annual wellness credit), free annual biometric screenings, and subsidized gym memberships up to \$50/month.

5. Expense Reimbursement & Travel Policy

All business expenses must be reasonable, necessary, and pre-approved when exceeding \$250. Personal expenses are never reimbursable.

****Daily Allowances (Per Diem)**:**

- ****Tier 1 cities**** (e.g., New York, San Francisco, London, Tokyo): Maximum ****\$90 USD/day**** for meals and incidentals.

- ****Tier 2 cities**** and all other locations: Maximum ****\$60 USD/day****.

Alcohol is ****explicitly non-reimbursable**** unless it is part of an approved client entertainment event with ****more than 4 attendees**** and documented business purpose. Receipts are required for all individual expenses over \$25.

****Submission Deadline**:** All expense reports must be submitted through the ****Expensify**** platform by the ****5th calendar day**** of the month following the expense month. Any expense submitted ****more than 60 days after the**

transaction date will be **strictly rejected** and become the employee's personal responsibility.**

Travel policy requires use of approved booking tools (Concur), economy class for flights under 6 hours, and mid-tier hotels. International travel requires VP-level approval at least 21 days in advance.

6. Code of Conduct & Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

****Code of Conduct**:** Employees must maintain professional standards, protect confidential information, avoid conflicts of interest, and comply with all anti-harassment, anti-discrimination, and data protection laws (GDPR, CCPA, etc.). Violations are investigated promptly by HR with potential involvement of external counsel.

****Disciplinary Tiers** (progressive unless severity warrants escalation):**

1. ****Written Warning**** – Documented discussion and 30-day monitoring period.
2. ****Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)****.
3. ****Immediate Termination**** for cause (e.g., gross misconduct, policy violations involving ethics or security).

****The PIP Process**:**

- Duration: ****Exactly 45 calendar days****.
- Milestones reviewed ****bi-weekly**** (every 14 days) with written feedback.
- PIP must include specific, measurable, achievable targets with success criteria defined upfront (e.g., "Complete 100% of assigned tickets at 'Meets Expectations' quality by week 6").
- If the employee fails to meet ****100% of the outlined PIP targets**** by the end of day 45, ****termination occurs automatically on day 46**** with no further notice period (subject to local legal requirements).

- Employees on PIP are ineligible for promotion, transfer, or discretionary bonuses during the plan and for 90 days after successful completion.

This handbook does not create a contract of employment. Employment at AuraTech Solutions is at-will where permitted by law. Employees are encouraged to contact HR with questions.

****Acknowledgment**:** By continuing employment or signing digitally in WorkforceHub, employees confirm they have read, understood, and agree to abide by all policies contained herein.

AuraTech Solutions – Building the Future, Together.